

The Glorious King of Tantras, the Tantra of the King of Wisdom of Great Power

Śrī Mahābala Jñānarāja Tantra Rāja · Toh 410 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 410 in the Kangyur is a Buddhist tantric scripture known in English as The Glorious King of Tantras, the Tantra of the King of Wisdom of Great Power, in Sanskrit as the Śrī Mahābala Jñānarāja Tantra Rāja, and in Tibetan as Dpal stobs chen po ye shes kyi rgyal po'i rgyud. It belongs to the class of tantric texts and opens in the characteristic style of a discourse delivered by the Buddha, here depicted as dwelling in a sacred tantric setting surrounded by hero-vajras, ḍākinīs, and māmākīs, with the hero-vajra posing a question after offering homage. The text concerns the profound wisdom teachings associated with Vajrasattva and the tantric pantheon of enlightened beings. It was translated into Tibetan by the Indian paṇḍita Gayādhara together with the Tibetan monk-translator Śākya Yeshe, a celebrated partnership responsible for transmitting a number of important tantric works into the Tibetan canon.

The King is complete.

Translated by the paṇḍita Gayādhara and the translator, the monk Śākya Yeshe.

In the language of India: Śrī Mahābala Jñānarāja Tantra Rāja. In the Tibetan language: The Glorious King of Tantras, the Tantra of the King of Wisdom of Great Power.

Homage to the glorious Vajrasattva (Skt. vajrasattva).

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling within the bhaga of the Lady of Suchness, surrounded by a retinue of hero-vajras (vīras) and ḍākinīs and hosts of māmākīs. The hero-vajra, together with the ḍākinīs and the rest, circumambulated to the left three times, then took their place to one side. The hero-vajra touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One, uttered three times the syllable "Hā hā," and addressed the Blessed One with this question:

What are the channels, what are the winds,
what are the drops, and what their number?
How is mind to be grasped within them?
What are the wheels, what is their nature,

and how many in their count?
What is the intrinsic nature of the channels?
What is the method of placing the syllables?
Among these, at the central navel point,
which syllables are placed where?
How is the fierce one (caṇḍālī) to be kindled?
What are the moon and the sun?
Where is the location to be held?
What are the two conditions, and how are the wheels?
What is the manner of the reversal?
What are the four secret wheels?
What is the intention of all these,
and how do bliss and the rest arise?
What are the sixteen emptinesses?
What are the successive stages of the grounds?
What is the intent of all these,
and what is the intent of their purpose?

The Blessed One declared: Listen well, O hero-vajra.
I shall explain to you — receive it well.

The intrinsic nature of the channels
produces all things in the non-dual space of the sky.
The intrinsic nature of the wind dwelling therein
is movement — it is the movement of consciousness.
The essential nature of the drop is emptiness,
emptiness beyond all thought.
The number of the drops is sixteen,
and so likewise the channels and the winds.

Now I shall teach the grasping of mind:
upon channels, winds, and drops,
the initial mind is non-dual and one-pointed.

The number of the wheels is four:
the wheel of great bliss, the wheel of enjoyment, the wheel of Dharma,
and below that, the wheel of emanation —
each of these has four, and four again,
and sixteen in number should they be known.

Fire and wind are the two conditions.
There is the wheel of Rasanā itself,
and at the crown, the wheel that is the abode of empowerment.
The four secret wheels are these:
the first is the wheel that sustains bliss;
the second is the enjoyment wheel of Hayagrīva;
the third is the wheel of awareness;
the fourth is the secret wheel.
Their number is taught as twenty-four.

I shall explain the intrinsic nature of the channels:
the channels are of the nature of earth,
and also of the nature of wind and drops.

Now, the placing of the syllables:
at the wheel of great bliss, thirty-two —
the thirty-two consonants are to be placed going clockwise from the right.
At the spokes of the enjoyment wheel, sixteen —
the sixteen vowels are to be placed going counterclockwise from the left.
At the wheel of Dharma, with eight petals —
the seeds of the four mothers are placed going counterclockwise from the left;
the method is at the interstices, placed clockwise from the right.
At the petals of the emanation wheel —
all sixty-four of them —
the consonants are to be placed going clockwise from the right;
paired with the vowels, placed counterclockwise from the left.

At the central hub of the wheel of great bliss,
visualize the syllable HAM, white, facing downward.
At the central hub of the enjoyment wheel,
visualize the syllable OM, white, facing upward.
At the central hub of the wheel of Dharma,
visualize the syllable HŪM, blue, facing downward.
At the central hub of the emanation wheel,
visualize the syllable ĀḤ, red, facing upward.

The wheels of conditions are two.
At the location of the first is the syllable YAM.
The YAM is the blazing of the fierce one,
arisen from a complete transformation into darkness —

The wind wheel, dark in color, is bow-shaped.
In its center, place the five DHAs,
adorned by five banners.

At the triangular location is the syllable RAṂ.
The fire wheel is triangular and red.
In its center, place OM̐, ĀḤ, and HŪṂ.
At each corner it is marked with three vajras.
Such is the wheel of conditions.

Stirred by the wind, the samaya fire
is skillful in arousing the fire of wisdom.
The fire of wisdom it skillfully arouses.

The four wheels, or the eight and two, are explained.
All except the great bliss wheel are burned by just two.
The HAṂ of great bliss is melted,
and the nectar of immortal amṛta,
the nectar of the melting moon,
flows down from within the channel of life.

As it flows in a continuous stream,
there are two drops of immortality.
The apprehended is held within the knot of the held.
It is reversed in the manner of reversal —
this is the holding in the ultimate abode.

The fourth, the secret wheel,
is the secret wheel that sustains bliss.
HŪṂ is placed at its hub.
The count of petals is fifty-eight.
These are to be placed according to the manner of illumination.
The two sequences of vowels are arranged clearly,
beginning from the last and ending with what is abandoned.
It is called the "bliss-sustaining" because it wards off evil.
For this reason it is explained as the bliss-sustaining wheel.

On the petals of the Hayagrīva wheel,
the vowels are placed in regular and reverse order.
At the hub, place the syllable U.
It is called the Hayagrīva wheel

because it brings the experience of the riches of bliss.

The awareness wheel has five petals.

At the hub place HAM̐.

On the five petals, OM̐ HŪM̐ TRĀM̐ A —
these are placed in sequence from the right.

Its fourth meaning is awareness,
and so it is explained as the awareness wheel.

The secret wheel has six levels:

hub, four petals, eight petals,
sixteen, thirty-two,
and sixty-four — so it is explained.

At the hub, place the syllable A.

E, VAM̐, MA, YĀ — these
are placed on the four petals from the left.

On the eight petals are to be placed
the first eight of the eight classes,
arranged in sequence from the left.

On the sixteen petals,
the sixteen māmākī are placed from the left.

On the thirty-two petals and so forth,
the sixteen vowel syllables
are placed in sequence from right and left.

On the sixty-four petals,
the kālī series is placed from the right in proper order.
The two sequences of āli are placed from the left.

Because it confers the secret empowerment,
it is explained as the secret wheel.

Next is the Romā wheel,
which has two petals together with the hub.

On the two petals of the four neuter ones,
at the hub, that very syllable is placed facing downward.

The precious summit — contemplate it:

BHYA^H is placed facing upward.

Between the two syllables, in the center,

one tastes the flavor of bliss of the awakening mind.
For the sake of experiencing that taste,
it is explained as the taste-experience Romā wheel.

Next is the empowerment wheel
at the upper Brahmā gate, with eight petals.
At the hub, place AM.
DĀṂ, LĀṂ, KHĀṂ, RŪṂ —
beginning from the left, placed in the four directions.
HŪṂ, TRĀṂ, HRĪḤ, A —
placed in sequence at the intermediate directions from the right.

Because the stream of awakening mind
washes away the obscurations of body, speech, and mind,
empowerment is bestowed.
Therefore it is explained as the empowerment wheel.

Now what is further to be explained
is the concise meditation — let it be taught.
Whatever was shown above
should be understood as mere illusion.
Self-awareness is nothing other than mind itself.
The emptiness of one's own mind,
in its nature of luminous clear light —
if one comes to know it, thinking nothing whatsoever,
even without meditating, that itself is meditation.
In this way, hold the mind well.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, the hero Vajra and the other
heroes, the ḍākinīs, the māmākī and the other members of the inconceivable
retinue rejoiced and, having made outer, inner, and secret offerings, vanished
from sight.

The wondrous king of tantras, the Tantra of the Glorious Great-Power King of
Wisdom, is complete.

This was translated by the Indian paṇḍita Gāyadhara and —
and the Tibetan translator, the monk —

Translator's Notes

